

CompTIA A+ Core 1 Playbook

IT Labs

Prepared by Garrick White

Upgrade a Video Card

A customer wants to upgrade the video card in their computer to provide more memory, faster processing power, and additional features.

- Remove the existing cable and video card from both the computer and the monitor. Be sure to remove the cable first.
- Install a video card that will meet the customer's needs. Make sure to provide power to the card if necessary.
- Connect the video card to the monitor using the correct cable.
- Power on the computer and verify that the new card works.

On a real computer, you would need to install additional drivers and other software to take advantage of all the hardware features available with the new GPU.

Complete this lab as follows:

1. Disconnect the monitor from the current video card.
 1. Switch to the **Back** views of the computer and monitor.
 2. Drag the **DB-15 Connector** video cable:
 - From the computer to the Workspace area.
 - From the monitor to the Inventory.
2. Remove the current video card from the computer.
 1. Switch to the **Motherboard** view of the computer.
 2. Drag the **VGA Video Adapter** from the computer to the Inventory.
3. Install a new video card.
 1. Open the **GPUs/Expansion Cards** section of the Inventory.
 2. Examine each card to figure out which one has an HDMI port.
 3. From the Inventory, drag the **Video Adapter, DVI-I, HDMI video** card to an open PCI Express slot on the motherboard.
 4. Select the **power supply** to find the power connector for the video card.
 5. From the Selected Item pane, drag a **6-pin PCIe power connector** to the power port on the right side of the video card.
4. Connect the computer to the monitor.
 1. Above the computer, select **Back**.
 2. Under Inventory, expand **Cables**.
 3. Select **HDMI to HDMI Cable**.
 4. From the Selected Item pane:
 - Drag an **HDMI Connector** to the HDMI port on the video card.
 - Drag the unconnected **HDMI Connector** to the HDMI port on the monitor.
 5. Switch to the **Front** views of the computer and monitor.
 6. Select the **power button** on the computer. If the monitor loads and displays the OS, the GPU is installed correctly.